Jallianwala Bagh of Amritsar for heckling a British woman in one of the City's bazaars'.[1] With the attack on Lajpat Rai 'a wave of horror and indignation swept through the crowd' and soon 'anger gripped the country'.[2] Lala Lajpat Rai died ten days later on 17 November 1928. There was massive public mourning. At a condolence meeting in Calcutta on 29 November 1928, Basanti Devi, the widow of the Bengali Congressman C.R. Das, a renowned nationalist, summed up the mood at large when she raged at her countrymen's inaction with the inflammatory words, 'I quake with shame and disgrace.' She demanded to know whether 'the youth and manhood of the country still exist'.[3] This is when Bhagat Singh 'swore to avenge the insult'.[4] The HSRA began to plot revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai's death. It was to be the first of the strategic attacks on public officials which the revolutionaries described as 'Actions'.[5]

And so it was, that two days before the planned assassination in revenge of the killing of Lajpat Rai, four men from the HSRA met up on 15 December 1928 to plan the assassination of a state official. Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad, Rajguru and Jai Gopal were to have a dry run of their individual assignments in the planned plot. It was futile. J.A. Scott was to go out of town to Kasur on official police business on the day of his planned assassination on 17 December 1928. An ill-fated twenty-one-year-old probationary officer, J.P. Saunders, was the assistant superintendent of police who found himself leaving work at the Anarkali Police Station on a cool breezy afternoon at 4.20 p.m. With his motor cycle he was gently making his way towards the gate which would open out onto the road. Before he got to the gate he heard someone cry out from behind him. It was the head constable, Chanan Singh. The young J.P. Saunders had forgotten to take his keys with him. Running out towards him, Chanan Singh thrust the keys into his hands. Saunders took them, put them in his pocket and sped out of the front gate onto the road. Suddenly, shots rang out. Jai Gopal, wearing a turban and a warm coat over a pair of loose trousers tied with a drawstring around the waist, had given the signal to Rajguru, who was wearing a felt cap and a cotton coat. Rajguru fired the first shot. Saunders was hit and fell off his motorcycle. As he lay there groaning, Bhagat Singh,